Shanghai Cooperation Organization.

On 23 December 2011 there was a visit by Foreign Minister of Thailand. There was a wide range of discussions covering bilateral, regional and international issues. Both leaders affirmed the strong bilateral ties between India and Thailand, and discussed ways to further strengthen cooperation in diverse areas such as trade, investment, security and defence cooperation, tourism, education, culture, science and technology, energy, infrastructure and civil aviation, etc.

There were also visits of German Chancellor Dr. Angela Merkel, 30 May 2011, followed by signing of several MoUs and agreements. There were also visits by Dr. Ram Baran Yadav, President of Nepal from 27 January–5 February 2011, Foreign Minister of Bahrain to India, 30 March 2011, visit of Secretary General of the National Security Council of Saudi Arabia, 29 March 2011, Foreign Minister of Nigeria for Joint Commission Meeting, 15–17 March 2011, visit of Foreign Minister of Philippines for the Meeting of India-Philippines Joint Commission on Bilateral Cooperation, 15 March 2011 and Foreign Ministers of Brazil and South Africa on 7–8 March 2011. There were also visits of Malaysian Deputy Prime Minister on 10 March 2011, visit of Prime Minister of Thailand, 5 April 2011, and visit of Foreign Minister of Cyprus on 19 April 2011. Month of May 2011 was followed by visits by Foreign Minister of Egypt and Iceland. Prime Minister of Slovenia, John Key visited India on 14 June 2011. Prime Minister of New Zealand paid a State visit to India in June 2011. July 2011 also saw a series of visits by Foreign Minister of Netherland, Libya and Poland and on 01August 2011 Foreign Minister of Syria.

The **year 2012** began with the visit of Minister of State (External Affairs) to Vietnam for attending the commemorative event for the 40th anniversary of establishment of full diplomatic relations between India and Vietnam (5 January). This was followed by another visit by Minister of State (External Affairs) to Palestine and Israel (10 January). External Affairs Minister, S.M. Krishna visited Sri Lanka from 16–19 January 2012. Both sides reviewed progress in various areas, including trade, services and investment, development cooperation, science and technology, culture and education. MoUs